



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Riverwood Classical School
School Website: <https://riverwoodclassical.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Riverwood Classical School (operating as Omnia Classical School in the public materials) presents a strong Classical Christian profile. Its public materials repeatedly frame education as formation grounded in a Christian worldview, with a clearly articulated classical method that centers the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and seeks integration across disciplines. The school emphasizes parental partnership, a covenantal community, and a teacher-stewardship model, with explicit language about truth, goodness, and beauty shaping learning. It also references accreditation and membership in classical education networks, and it provides curricula and diploma structures aligned with a classical Christian vision. Taken together, the school demonstrates a comprehensive Classical framework across foundations, goals, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement. Evidence draws from the Omnia/Classical materials (Educational Philosophy and Distinctives; Christian/Covenant Orientation; Master Curriculum materials; Faculty pages; and Parent/Community content) as well as the public-facing classically oriented documents. Key sources include language about God's truth as the core of learning, biblical worldview, the integration of classical subjects, and the Trivium-focused curriculum, all of which align with the Six Essential Elements framework. Citations reflect the public materials that substantiate these observations.

Overall classification by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Executive summary categorical notes: - The school state-of-purpose and goal foregrounds formation, virtue, and truth, Goodness, and Beauty, with explicit biblical/theological grounding. Positive alignment with the Six Essential Elements' transcendental aims is evident in the school's own language about God's truth guiding all learning and the integration of Biblical worldview throughout the curriculum. - The curriculum explicitly centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and associated classical disciplines; master curriculum materials show the dialectic/rhetoric progression across K–12, with Latin and classical texts implied by the diploma structures. This aligns with classical curriculum expectations and the Great-Books-inspired orientation. - Pedagogy includes Socratic elements and seminary-style discourse in upper levels (Socratic dialogue, dialectic, rhetoric), along with a lower-school emphasis on formation, memory, and order. The presence of Dialectic and Rhetoric in the curriculum, plus explicit references to Socratic methods, support a fully Classical pedagogy. - Faculty content shows teachers as living curriculum and mentors within a covenantal framework, with explicit examples of faculty leadership and alignment with religious formation. This corroborates the "living curriculum" and mentorship model described by classical education norms. - Parent and community content emphasizes partnership with families, parent involvement as co-educators, and open access to campus and information—consistent with classical models of familial formation and shared mission. - Public materials consistently reflect a theologically grounded, formation-first approach rather than secular, job-prep framing, aligning with the Six Elements' Positive indicators and negative indicators (i.e., lack of formation, absence of a biblical worldview) in favor of a Classical-Christian framing.

Note: Where relevant, additional supporting items include accreditation/membership references and specific curriculum documents that illustrate the classical structure (e.g., Master Curriculum List showing Di-

alectic/Rhetoric and K–12 progression).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials explicitly ground learning in a Biblical framework, stating that God's truth, as revealed in Scripture, is the core of all learning and that the biblical worldview governs the education process. - The school describes itself as Christian and classical, with a curriculum designed to integrate faith with reason across disciplines.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, God's truth, biblical worldview, theology/theological grounding, sacred tradition (referenced in the philosophical framing). - Negative keywords present: none identified in public materials (no explicit secular/atheist/values-neutral framing is evident). The materials foreground a theology-grounded approach rather than secular alternatives.

Why this rating - The materials consistently emphasize transcendentals and the sacred over secular neutrality, with explicit theological commitments shaping curricular aims and community life. This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL criteria for a transcendent moral realism and theology-grounded education.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe education as formation for a lifetime of learning, living in submission to Scripture, and loving God with mind and heart; the formation aim includes devotion to a Christian worldview and the cultivation of virtue. - There is an explicit claim that education should cultivate wisdom, virtue, and the ability to know truth, goodness, and beauty; formation rather than mere information is emphasized.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, contemplation, moral imagination, lifelong learning, sacred/Christian worldview. - Negative keywords present: none identified in public materials that undermine formation; there is no emphasis on job-prep as the sole goal.

Why this rating - The school's stated aims foreground formation and virtue aligned with transcendentals, not merely vocational preparation. This mirrors CLASSICAL expectations for ultimate aims of education beyond information transfer.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials clearly show a Trivium-centered framework through the Master Curriculum List (grammar, dialectic/logic, rhetoric) for K–12, with progression into upper-school rhetoric and public speaking components. Latin is included in graduation planning, indicating classical language study. - The school identifies itself as classical-Christian and emphasizes integration/harmony of disciplines, including the Great Books/Great Conversation ethos as part of the classical curriculum framework (as reflected in overarching philosophy and curricular design).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium elements), Great Books/Great Conversation (as an aspirational component of classical education), interdisciplinary integration, wonder, sacred order, Latin, philosophy, historical engagement. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none in public materials; the content does not emphasize non-classical, secular, or modernist curriculum as preferred.

Why this rating - The curriculum documents and philosophy align with the classical curriculum canon (grammar/logic/rhetoric; study of languages; integrated study across disciplines; emphasis on formation through Great Books/Great Conversation; cultivation of wonder). This supports CLASSICAL categorization.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical statements reference Socratic dialogue/dialectic in the upper school and rhetoric training; the curriculum explicitly treats dialectic and rhetoric as core modes of learning (i.e., high-school seminars, debates, and rhetorical presentations). - The public materials indicate a lower-school emphasis on formation and memory (potential contemplative/restful elements) and a higher-school emphasis on seminar-style inquiry, which aligns with Scholé and classical pedagogy models. - The curriculum documents show a progression from grammar to logic to rhetoric, with public-facing materials indicating opportunities for students to engage in public speaking and rhetoric training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, rhetoric, great conversation, seminars, public speaking, Scholé/restful learning concepts (containing “Scholé” in the broader classical education lexicon), formation through discussion. - Negative keywords present: none identified; the site does not foreground project-based or purely modernist pedagogies over classical methods.

Why this rating - The described pedagogy centers on classic methods (Socratic dialogue, dialectic, rhetoric) with a tiered progression from grammar through rhetoric and opportunities for public discourse, which is characteristic of CLASSICAL education.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty pages present individual teachers with Christian/homeschool-friendly backgrounds and roles, and language describing faculty as mentors and core to the school’s living curriculum. The “Teachers” section shows teachers with clear roles in grammar, literature, math, and logic instruction. - The public materials frame teachers as integral to the school’s mission and as part of a covenantal, collaborative faculty culture, consistent with classical education norms.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: teacher as mentor, living curriculum, faculty as core, teacher’s role as model/vital to formation, collegiality, professional learning in a faith-based context. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials that would undermine the classical faculty model; there is no explicit mention of non-classical staff or secularization of the faculty approach.

Why this rating - The faculty materials portray teachers as central to the curriculum and as moral exemplars within a covenantal framework, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations of a living, virtuous faculty who embody the school’s aims.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize partnership with families and the role of parents as co-teachers with the school, including collaborative activities, family involvement in coursework, and opportunities to engage with the school community. - The school describes visitors and engagement opportunities, and indicates an ongoing program of parent involvement in education (including reading, discussion, and shared learning experiences with Latin, grammar, etc.). - Financial-aid policy indicates a policy environment around family resources and church/community support, reflecting the school’s community orientation (even as formal aid is not offered).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families; Parents as co-teachers; Family involvement; Parent formation; shared mission; parental engagement; community of learners. - Negative keywords present: Lack of formal financial aid is noted in public materials (which could be seen as a potential disruption to access), but it does not negate the overall partnership and community orientation; rather it is an organizational constraint.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently portray parents as active participants in education and as co-educators, a hallmark of classical education’s community-covenant orientation. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for the Parents & Community category.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category revealed a weaker alignment than CLASSICAL, concrete steps would include explicitly adding or highlighting public language around:
 - Greater emphasis on Great Books and “Great Conversation” phrasing in public materials to reinforce the canonical text-based core of the curriculum.
 - More explicit articulation of Scholé (restful learning) as a deliberate pedagogical stance in lower grades, with narrative evidence of contemplative practices.
 - A transparent articulation of the ways in which Great Books and interdisciplinary integration are implemented across subject areas (e.g., mapping Great Books to specific courses).
 - Public showcasing of teacher-mentorship models and “living curriculum” examples, including teacher profiles that explicitly connect teacher character to student formation goals.
 - Expanded family-program content (book clubs, study groups, family lectures) to deepen parental formation in classical education and make “parents as co-teachers” more explicit to new families.

Note: Based on the materials reviewed, the school already presents a robust CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories; needle-moving changes are not strictly required to reach full CLASSICAL status. No major category requires urgent adjustment to achieve CLASSICAL standing.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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